

Muhammad Sayyid

Application Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Application Security Engineer specializing in API Security and Cloud-Native environments. Experienced in threat modeling, OWASP API Security Top 10, secure code review, and hardening Node.js/containerized applications. Full-Stack background (MERN) enables deep understanding of application internals — from API design to deployment security.

SKILLS

AppSec & Security: Secure Code Review, OWASP Top 10, White-box Testing, Vulnerability Management (Trivy), Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, RBAC, OWASP API Security Top 10, JWT Security, API Security Testing, Broken Object Level Authorization (BOLA), SAST, DAST, Penetration Testing, DevSecOps, XSS, SQLi, CSRF, IDOR, SSRF, Secure SDLC, OAuth2, Nmap.

Tools & Infrastructure: Docker (Security), Linux (Bash), Git/GitHub, Postman, CI/CD Security, AWS (IAM, S3, Lambda Security).

Backend Development: Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, Supabase, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Python (Basics).

Frontend Development: React.js, Next.js, Redux Toolkit, Tailwind CSS, React Query, Context API.

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

In Progress: Burp Suite Certified Practitioner (BSCP)

Planned: eJPT – Junior Penetration Tester (INE)

EXPERIENCE

Independent AppSec Consultant — <0xMS /> Freelance

- Service Offerings:** Operate an independent Application Security consulting practice, offering API security assessments and secure code review services
- Platform Presence:** Maintain a professional consulting presence on Upwork and Freelancer.com around AppSec service positioning, with defined service pricing for API security assessments and code reviews
- Applied Security Work:** Apply hands-on offensive security skills through independent research, including a full black-box penetration test of a live WordPress application (see Projects)

PROJECTS

Black-Box Penetration Test — extenra.com

Conducted an independent black-box penetration test against a live WordPress-based website.

- Vulnerability Discovery:** Identified and confirmed two high-severity CORS misconfigurations on Contact Form 7 plugin endpoints
- Proof of Concept:** Developed working PoC exploits demonstrating real-world exploitability
- Reporting:** Documented findings in a structured security assessment report

Tech Stack: Burp Suite Professional, manual black-box testing methodology.

Hardened Node.js Runtime Environment

Designed a secure containerization workflow for a Node.js application, focusing on attack surface reduction.

- Attack Surface Reduction:** Migrated to Alpine Linux, reducing image size by 60% and minimizing potential CVEs
- Access Control:** Prevented privilege escalation by configuring containers to run as non-root users
- Security Scanning:** Integrated Trivy to automate High/Critical vulnerability detection during build

- **API Security Layer:** Configured Express.js security middleware (helmet, rate limiting, input sanitization) to protect REST API endpoints against injection and enumeration attacks

Tech Stack: Docker, Trivy, Linux, Node.js.

The Wild Oasis (Hotel Management System)

Based on Jonas Schmedtmann's Ultimate React Course project; extended independently with a security-focused layer.

- **Access Control:** Implemented RBAC via Supabase and applied strict input validation to ensure data integrity
- **Secure Architecture:** Developed a secure React SPA with efficient remote state management using React Query

Tech Stack: React.js, Supabase (Auth/DB), React Query.

WorldWise (Travel Tracking App)

Based on Jonas Schmedtmann's Ultimate React Course project; extended independently with API and data-exposure security hardening.

- **API Security:** Secured user routes and sanitized third-party API (Leaflet) inputs to prevent vulnerabilities
- **Data Exposure Prevention:** Managed global state securely via Context API to avoid data exposure issues

Tech Stack: React.js, Context API, CSS Modules.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology 09/2023 – 06/2027 (Expected)

Zagazig University, Zagazig, Egypt

Major: Marketing & E-commerce Technology | Cumulative Grade: Very Good

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native/Bilingual